

Karn

2026, Ruben Hillier

https://www.reddit.com/r/abstractgames/comments/1vr1x8g/karn_a_3d_board_game_of_architectural_warfare/

The aim is to build as high as possible and have the most pieces at the highest level. You and your opponent should use strategies to both gain height while trying to stop each other. You can hinder your opponent by blocking them off; this can be done in many ways, and you must plan your structure to give yourself the most options and give your opponent the least.

There are three types of pieces: blocks (15 per player), pillars (10 per player), and platforms (20) shared between both players. The game is played on an 8x8 board.



This is a turn-based game starting with white, then black. You start by placing a building block on the board, and then your opponent does the same; from there, you need to work out how to build up and block your opponent from doing the same.

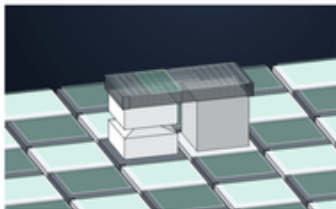
Rules:

1. Blocks and Pillars may only be placed on the Board or on a Platform.
2. A Platform may only be placed between a Block and a Pillar that are orthogonally adjacent and on the same level.
3. You cannot place a building piece on the part of a Platform directly above a Block, unless your Platform is owned (see Rule 6); then a Pillar can be placed in that area.

4. Your opponent's pieces are inverted for you: their Blocks act as Pillars, and their Pillars act as Blocks.
5. You cannot place a Pillar next to an opponent's Block unless that Block has a Platform above it.
6. A Platform is owned by you if both supporting pieces are yours, shared if one supporting piece is yours, and off-limits if neither supporting piece is yours. You cannot build on a Platform that is off-limits to you.
7. A 2×1 tower may only continue directly upward for two Platforms. To build higher, the next Platform must connect from a different stack or direction.
8. Running out of legal moves: If your move leaves you with no legal moves, your opponent gets one final turn, and then the game ends. If your move leaves your opponent with no legal moves, that move counts as the final turn and the game ends immediately.
9. Scoring: When the game ends, find the highest occupied level, where a level encompasses all platforms at the same height and building blocks on them. On that level, Blocks score 1, Pillars score 2, and Platforms owned by you score 1.

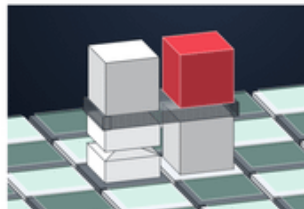
The player with the highest occupied level wins. If both players have the same score on the highest occupied level, the game is a draw.

Building:



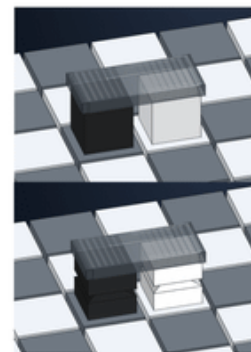
Rule 1 – Blocks and Pillars may only be placed on the Board or on a Platform.

Rule 2 – A Platform may only be placed between a Block and a Pillar that are orthogonally adjacent and on the same level.



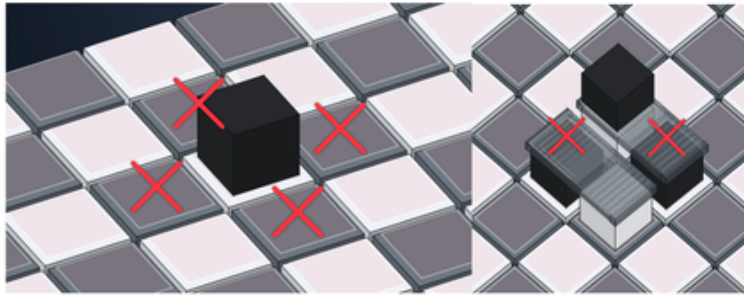
Rule 3 – You cannot place a building piece on the part of a Platform directly above a Block.

Red pieces are illegally placed



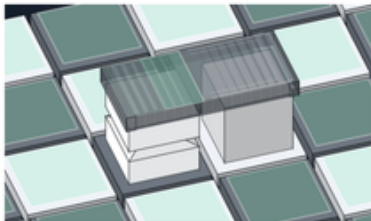
Rule 4 – Your opponent's pieces are inverted for you: their Blocks act as Pillars, and their Pillars act as Blocks.

Where you can't place pillars:

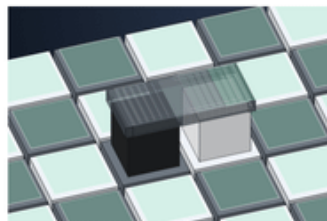


Rule 5 – You cannot place a Pillar next to an opponent's Block unless that Block has a Platform above it.

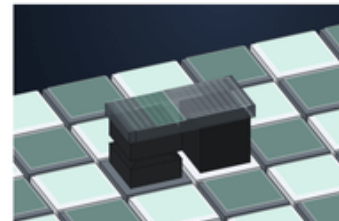
Platform mechanics:



Owned platform



Shared platform

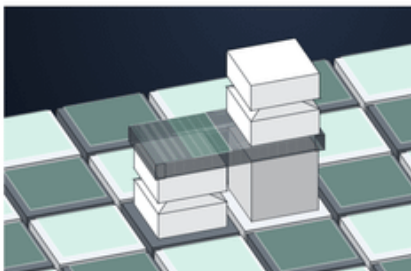


Off-limits

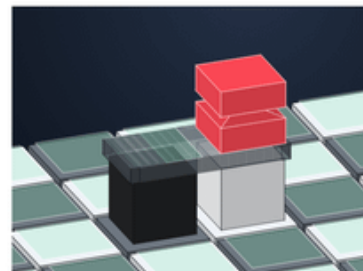
Rule 6 – A Platform is owned by you if both supporting pieces are yours, shared if one supporting piece is yours, and off-limits if neither supporting piece is yours. You cannot build on a Platform that is off-limits to you.

You are playing white

Building on owned platforms:



Owned platform.

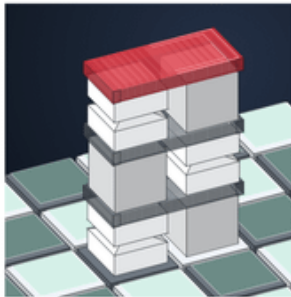


Shared platform

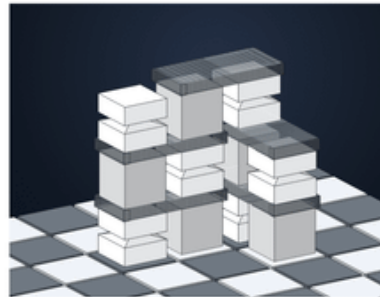
Rule 7 – On a Platform you own, you may place a Pillar directly above your own Block. This is an exception to Rule 3.

Red pieces are illegally placed

Keep builds structurally sound.



Don't do this



To reach higher, do something like this.

Rule 8 – A 2×1 tower may only continue directly upward for two Platforms. To build higher, the next Platform must connect from a different stack or direction.

Red pieces are illegally placed

End game:



Score = 1 for both opponents, so a draw, as they both have a block on the highest level.



White has a score of 2 because they have a pillar on the highest level, while black has no pieces at this level and therefore has a score of 0. So, white wins.

Rule 10 – Scoring: When the game ends, find the highest occupied level. On that level, Blocks score 1, Pillars score 2, and Platforms owned by you score 1.